

Project 06: Installation Art

Course Code and Title: MSJ2102, Convergence Communication 1

Project Title: Trash into Treasure

Date: Spring 2023

Project Description

As part of this coursework we did a 'Trashion Show' that was based on the CI theme, which involved some structured coursework before and after. The project was carried out in a group and each member worked on a specific section of the project as assigned by us as a project team under the project name Trash into Treasure. Our specific focus is determined by the theme of the semester, where our project has been chosen to be on the topic of 'Fast Fashion & Sustainable Consumption' and we will be exploring how people can be driven to extreme consumer habits that contribute to environmental degradation.

Once we settled for our theme and topic, we started to plan our set-up, design our clothes, and list the materials that we need to use in the project and need to upcycle. Two complete outfits were designed for our models with some recycled and discarded textiles, plastic bottle caps and waste from the streets which can be creatively re-used. The materials used were collected locally and the costumes were hand-stitched and/or fabricated together.

Once we had completed our clothes, we went to the ULAB Research Building Auditorium to take part in the "live runway" show with 2 of our group members who performed on the runway and showcased our garments on the cat walk along with a handmade banner "Fast Fashion, Fast Damage". After viewing the exhibition, each member made a personal report covering the theme, the topic, the production process, the visual materials and the qualitative visitor's responses, to assess the communicative value of our art.

Project justification :

Visual and performance culture and creative advocacy are now vital tools and techniques in modern communication studies for reaching audiences on pertinent socio-environmental issues. The "Trash into Treasure" project is part of this portfolio and is a concrete, high impact example of the ability to convert academic theory into a real public performance.

The project is based on the theme of the semester, Group Polarization and examines the societal trends and peer pressure that leads individuals to consume clothing to the extremes that are unsustainable. The project combines critical discussion with practical media production, ranging from the gathering of waste from the municipal dumpster, to the hand-stitching of discarded clothes, to co-creating upcycled clothing. In addition, the direct experience of performing on the stage as the male model offered valuable experience in live visual storytelling, non-verbal communication and stage presence. This project not only showcases a full range of skills in campaign design, performance advocacy, and evaluating audience feedback, but also includes post-event audience interviews to assess message clarity.

Department of Media Studies and Journalism

University of Liberal Arts Bangladesh

Midterm Examination | Summer semester, 2023

MSJ 11214: Convergence Communication 1 (Sec 1)



Full Mark: 25

Deadline: Aug 26, 2023

Each student must individually fill up the following form to write the report on her/his group/individual project for the final term examination.

Reporter's ID: 213012001

Reporter's name: Yeasir Arafat

Question	Answer	Poin
Title of your work:	Model	01

Group details (if any)		
Group name:	TRASH INTO TREASURE	01
Group member's list. (Write your group members' names with their IDs.)	Member's ID	Member's name
	222012034	SAD BIN ABBAS SANIM
	222012046	Ammar Binte Babul Trowya
	222012008	NAVID MUSTAKIM
	222012007	IRFANUL ALAM
Theme		
CI theme: (Write about the semester theme 'Group Polarization' in your language.) (50-150 words)	Group polarization refers to the phenomenon where the opinions and attitudes of individuals within a group become more extreme after discussing a topic or making a decision together. This shift towards a more extreme position is typically in line with the initial leanings of the group members, and it occurs due to a combination of social comparison and persuasive arguments. As individuals seek validation and approval from their peers, they may amplify their initial	01

	viewpoints to align with the perceived majority opinion. Group polarization can be observed in various contexts, from political discussions to business decisions. The phenomenon can lead to more informed and nuanced decisions in some cases, but it can also result in increased divisiveness and radicalization if the initial opinions are extreme. Understanding group polarization is crucial for promoting constructive group dynamics and making informed decisions while considering the potential biases that might arise during group discussions.	
Group/Individual theme: (What was your theme? Why did you take this theme?) (150-250 words)	In the current epoch of rapid-paced fashion trends, individuals appear to be visually impaired to their own consumption habits. The accumulation of clothing has reached a stage where numerous garments are procured, often with the sole purpose of being worn for a single photograph or a specific event, only to be relegated to a neglected heap shortly thereafter. The very outfit we are currently showcasing carries a narrative rooted in discarded materials found strewn across the streets of Mirpur. However, it's essential to acknowledge that what we are exhibiting represents just a fraction of the overall waste produced. Contemplate the extensive volume of refuse generated as a consequence of the relentless surge of fast fashion. This exhibition is intended to elicit a contemplative query in the minds of our observers: Could it be plausible that the ecological toll inflicted by fast fashion transcends the boundaries of our imagination? The thematic framework we've embraced functions as a platform to illuminate the pertinent matter of sustainability and to stimulate introspection regarding the far-reaching implications of our sartorial selections. Through this presentation, our aim is to catalyze a discourse concerning the adverse ecological impacts of fast fashion and to incite a collective reevaluation of our patterns of consumption.	02
Artwork		

Layout & Plan: (Attach the image of your layout) (Why and what kind of fashion did you want to do?) (150-250 words)	Garments constitute an integral aspect of the five fundamental human rights. However, in our engagement with these objects, we often engage in wasteful practices, acquiring more than necessary, resulting in eventual disuse and a detrimental impact on the environment. Our primary objective is to fashion our attire using surplus fabric. Our approach involves enlisting two models, a son and a daughter, and harnessing the collective effort of our team to amass unused clothing. These accumulated garments will then be skillfully integrated to create a unique design. To enhance the aesthetic appeal, we intend to incorporate soft water lids as decorative elements. Through this initiative, we aim to highlight the significance of responsible consumption, transforming unused articles into a creative manifestation that underscores the importance of minimizing waste and its ecological implications. By repurposing fabric and repackaging it into an innovative form, we strive to communicate the message of sustainability while fostering a tangible example of resourcefulness and mindful practices.	02
Production: (Please write about the production process of your work from the beginning including materials you used, the place you worked at, any obstacles you faced, any improvisation you did, the result came out at the end.) (Please attach some images of your production process.) (300-400 words)	At first we faced some initial challenges in planning. Which left us quite confused about how to start our project. Initially the task turned out to be much more complicated than we expected. In between, one of our group mates goes to Swachh Gujarat, due to which, we have to get more speed. Also, due to the storm and rain, I myself went to Naveed's house for 2 days, wet. His house is Bangmaltar. Then I bought a raincoat and saved myself from getting wet. Despite raining ideas from all, a final decision remains elusive. Ultimately, a consensus has emerged to direct our efforts toward solving the problem of fast fashion. With this resolution, we started collecting lots of old clothes to repurpose. From my own family, I managed to collect a sack full of discarded clothes. Others also diligently scavenged for materials abandoned in their respective places. During this process, an unexpected obstacle arose, prompting a change in our strategy. We decided to incorporate pieces of polythene and bottle caps on the fabric. Our collaborative efforts extended to collecting bottle caps from local shops and reclaiming plastic bags from various streets. Additionally, we removed buttons from the collected clothing items and attached them. Complicating matters, none of us had any sewing skills. Funny thing is that since I was a	04

	model, the pants I wore had a small tear on the bottom, which I sewed by hand on the day of the show. This obstacle helped me learn a new job personally. In the final stages of this project, there was apprehension – uncertainty about the outcome of the dress, doubt about our ability to carry it on the ramp and execute it successfully. Gradually, however, a sense of reassurance blossomed, creating a growing confidence within the group. Our achievement was truly a collective effort. The success and beauty of the end result depends on the contribution of each group member. As soon as the dress making and traction show was over, I left for a trip to Khulna and returned home after 1 day. And after returning home, I sewed my boots by myself because of the experience. I am very happy with it. Despite the initial moments of exhaustion, a deep sense of satisfaction washed over me as the project reached its climax. The experience provided valuable insight into effective teamwork and collaboration, an experience I will no doubt take forward. And I am especially grateful to all of my team. And many thanks to Maunta, Banni and Suhi for explaining things in a very simple way.	
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Exhibition





Exhibition: (Where was the show, how was that platform, who were the spectators, was any other platform better for the show, and why?) (150 -250 words) (Please attach some images/screenshots of your final work and show)	The event was held in the auditorium of Research Building, Ulab. The decoration of the auditorium was particularly spectacular, and the credit went to the organizers of the event. The people of the event also beautifully lit up the stage layout, which was quite pleasing and charming. Considering multiple teams used the same stage, it would have been beneficial if the stage was wider. From my point of view, it might be wise to consider holding this event in a larger capacity venue in the future. A move to a larger venue seems justified given the evolving dynamics of event attendance. While previously limited to students from the media department, organizers now include students from various departments. Even, the presence of parents has increased significantly. The popularity of the program among different demographics suggests the need for a broader space. By moving to a larger venue, the event can accommodate the growing enthusiasm and interest. This will ensure that all attendees, including the extended audience and their parents, can participate in the event comfortably. Higher engagement potential and greater outreach make offering a larger venue a logical progression for the event's continued success. Because celebrities like Bibi Russell and fashion veterans have come here so we who were models tried to surround ourselves and did as much as we could. Wish Yulebe would do this kind of event in the future.	02
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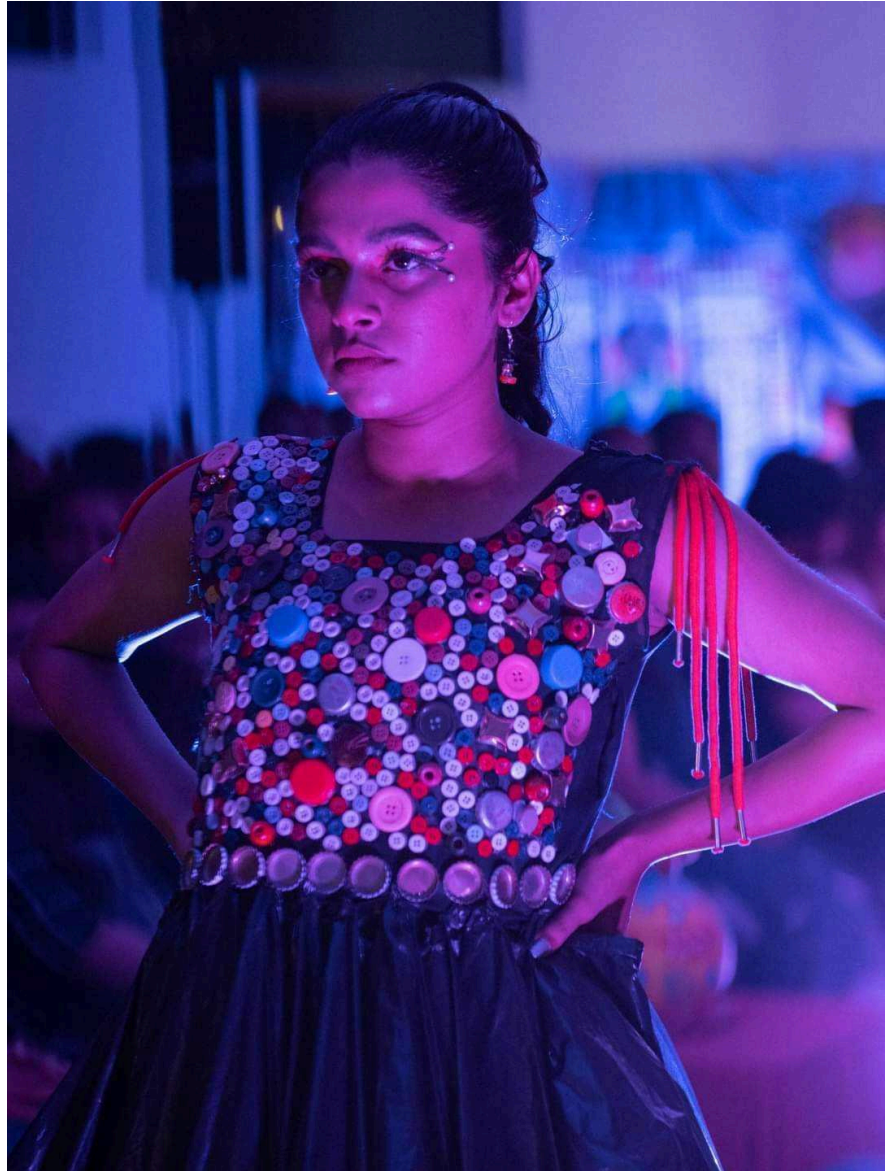
















Feedback

(Please interview 5 people and ask the same 5 questions to each person to fill up the table below.)

(Please edit question number 5 with your message in it, before you send the questions to your interviewee.)

Question

Answer

Interviewee:1

1. Please tell me your name and profession (in detail).

Name:WASIAM HASAN
DIGONTO

Profession (in detail):STUDENT
FROM AHSANULLAH UNIVERSITY
FROM IPE DEPARTMENT

2. Please tell me what message you get after seeing my artwork, or is it very confusing and very hard to understand?

After seeing the dress I first thought it was a brigadier's dress.. There were many buttons and some chains, but it was a bit confusing (at first) but when the description started the idea was clear.

3. If you get any message, which clues have helped you to understand the message?

The moment when the two performers exhibited a template or note crafted from jute fabric was an exceptionally distinctive hint that significantly enhanced the clarity of the message.

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4. Does this artwork look common or does it look extraordinary to you? If it looks unique or creative to you, what kind of uniqueness do you find in this work?	No it was totally uncommon for me.but its look extraordinary for me.its look very much creative.	
5. I wanted to tell you (write your message here). Have you found this message in this artwork? If my message could be more visible in it, please suggest it to me.	The artists might have incorporated some acting into their performances since they were restricted from speaking due to their role as models. Apart from that, I don't have any suggestions as I thoroughly enjoyed their creative expressions.	
Interviewee:2		
1. Please tell me your name and profession.	Name: sadia afrin oni	Profession (in detail): student From ulab bbA DEPARTMENT
2. Please tell me what message you get after seeing my artwork, or is it very confusing and very hard to understand?	It was not easier for me to understand the point of this show. It was so hard to understand for me and I really did enjoy the various types of dresses everyone made.after seeing this dress i thought its a joker dress.	
3. If you get any message, which clues have helped you to understand the message?	The materials utilized in the show aided in conveying the trashion show's message. Each group's attire carried a distinct meaning. For instance, the "Trash into Treasure" group emphasized their stance against fast fashion.	

4. Does this artwork look common or does it look extraordinary to you? If it looks unique or creative to you, what kind of uniqueness do you find in this work?	In my perspective, I found it extremely unique. I believe I haven't witnessed anything quite like it previously.	
5. I wanted to tell you (write your message here). Have you found this message in this artwork? If my message could be more visible in it, please suggest it to me.	I grasped their concept, although there was a brief moment of confusion until the commentary clarified it. Nonetheless, I found the concept intriguing and the message came across clearly to me.	
Interviewee:3		
1. Please tell me your name and profession.	Name: Hasina begum	Profession (in detail): housewife
2. Please tell me what message you get after seeing my artwork, or is it very confusing and very hard to understand?	While you were engaged in this project, I wasn't able to comprehend your actions. However, upon viewing the video showcasing the trashion show, I was truly impressed by the level of creativity and effort involved. The artwork conveyed a clear message and didn't present any confusion to me.	
3. If you get any message, which clues have helped you to understand the message?	Upon my initial viewing of the show's video, I experienced some confusion regarding the proceedings. However, upon closer inspection, I discerned that they had crafted garments from sustainable materials and conveyed various messages through their creations.	

4. Does this artwork look common or does it look extraordinary to you? If it looks unique or creative to you, what kind of uniqueness do you find in this work?	I believe this was a unique sight for me, and it held my fascination due to its intriguing and exceptional nature.	
5. I wanted to tell you (write your message here). Have you found this message in this artwork? If my message could be more visible in it, please suggest it to me.	Absolutely, witnessing the attire and the complete performance allowed me to grasp the concept and the messages being conveyed through your efforts. It highlighted the escalating concern of fast fashion, growing more alarming with each passing day.	
Interviewee:4		
1. Please tell me your name and profession.	Name: Rafid khan	Profession (in detail): student in iub from bba department.
2. Please tell me what message you get after seeing my artwork, or is it very confusing and very hard to understand?	Being a BBA student, I initially encountered some confusion. However, as soon as I watched the trashion show video, the message became quite evident to me.	
3. If you get any message, which clues have helped you to understand the message?	Initially, the concept wasn't entirely clear to me, but towards the conclusion, when they displayed the banner reading "Fast Fashion, Fast Damage" to the audience, it became certain that the theme revolved around fast fashion.	

4. Does this artwork look common or does it look extraordinary to you? If it looks unique or creative to you, what kind of uniqueness do you find in this work?	I had encountered similar work previously, yet this one stood out with its distinctiveness, showcasing a remarkable level of creativity evident in the attire.	
5. I wanted to tell you (write your message here). Have you found this message in this artwork? If my message could be more visible in it, please suggest it to me.	In my opinion, the models could have incorporated some acting to enhance the comprehensibility of the concept they were aiming to convey.	
Interviewee:5		
1. Please tell me your name and profession.	Name: Md ferdaus hasan hridoy	Profession (in detail): student From ulab msj department .
2. Please tell me what message you get after seeing my artwork, or is it very confusing and very hard to understand?	Although I possess considerable knowledge about art, it was truly captivating to observe how you transformed everyday discarded items into dresses	
3. If you get any message, which clues have helped you to understand the message?	As previously mentioned, my familiarity with art allowed me to grasp the message. Nonetheless, I must commend your excellent work in crafting the dresses and effectively demonstrating to people that trash can indeed be transformed into stunning garments.	

4. Does this artwork look common or does it look extraordinary to you? If it looks unique or creative to you, what kind of uniqueness do you find in this work?	This was a completely novel experience for me, as I hadn't encountered anything similar previously. The artwork presented was truly exceptional and held a distinctive quality.
5. I wanted to tell you (write your message here). Have you found this message in this artwork? If my message could be more visible in it, please suggest it to me.	I have no grievances or criticisms regarding the show and the concept you presented.
Realization	
07	

(Have you got all the feedback from the audience as you expected? Did the viewers get your message? Please explain the reasons why or why they did not get your message. What have you realized about your succession at the end? How should you do the fashion if you want to do it again? What were the strengths of your work? Why? What were your faults? How can you avoid your faults next time? What is your thought about this project?) (400-500 words)	Yes, i got all the feedback from the audience as i expected.yes all the viewers get my message.i realized lots of things and learn huge things .Participating in the Trash On Show event held at Ulab's Research Building was a truly enlightening experience that provided a new perspective and gained new knowledge in my understanding of fashion, sustainability and creative expression. Even gave the ability to do something new. The event not only showcased aesthetic design but served as a powerful catalyst for introspection and change. As I entered the auditorium of the Research Building, the atmosphere was alive with a unique mixture of anticipation and excitement. The surroundings were decorated with carefully crafted pieces that defied conventional expectations of fashion. What struck me deeply was the realization that fashion should not be divorced from sustainability. The combination of discarded materials, artistry and purpose demonstrates incredible potential for re-imagining the way we interact with clothing. Each ensemble's journey down the runway echoed a narrative of transformation – from waste to wonder. Witnessing the dedication participants poured into their creations, I couldn't help but reflect on the profound impact of individual actions. Each piece spoke volumes about the potential for conscious consumption, re-purposing and change that lies within our grasp. Beyond the iconic costumes, the event resonated with a sense of togetherness. It was a combination of like-minded people who recognized the urgency of addressing fashion's environmental impact. Conversations flowed freely, ideas were exchanged, and a palpable sense of community emerged. This shared commitment to sustainability illuminates the power of collective action and the potential for meaningful change when we come together around a common cause. Furthermore, the event emphasizes the role of creativity in driving change. The innovative use of materials that would otherwise be discarded highlights the limitless potential of human ingenuity. It proved that challenges can be reframed as opportunities, inviting us to rethink established norms and push the boundaries of our imagination. After the event, I find myself more in tune with the choices I make as a consumer. Traction event raised a higher awareness of fashion's environmental impact and creativity's ability to be a force for good. This inspired me to explore sustainable fashion options and shift towards a more conscious and responsible industry, contributing, albeit modestly. In essence, the Traction event at Ulab's Research Building was a meeting of creativity, sustainability and community. It has unleashed the potential of fashion to be a canvas for transformation and a vehicle for
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	meaningful conversation. As I reflect on this experience, I am reminded that change begins with individual actions—and together, those actions can become a movement that reshapes art, perspectives, and ultimately our world.	
Total		25

**** Report Submission deadline: Aug 26, 2023**

Learning and outcomes,

Use of Communication Theory: Knowledge of how collective consumer behavior and social trends contribute to the extreme consumption of fast fashion and wastefulness of the environment.

Non-Verbal & Performance Communication: Acquired confidence, stage presence and non-verbal storytelling skills by performing on the live stage as a male model with no verbal communication to tell a social message.

Hands-On Upcycling & Material Resourcefulness: Gained hands-on fabrication ability, such as sourcing materials, scavenging, using material from the street and manual hand-sewing under limited time constraints.

Audience Research & Data Collection: Developed the ability to plan and execute qualitative feedback interviews to assess the core message of the artwork with regard to an environmental message and how well they understood the message.

Collaborative Problem-Solving: Improved working in teams skills, coordinating different members' work, overcoming unplanned production challenges as they arose and delivering a multi-stage project, from layout to post event reporting.

